

The Balance Principle of Structural Persistence

Net consumption, recovery, and recovery-aware structural persistence

Akihito Sunagawa

April 29, 2026

要旨

The minimal form of structural persistence gives the closed shrinkage kernel

$$S = Me^{-L},$$

where L is cumulative structural consumption measured as logarithmic shrinkage of a feasible region.

This paper extends that kernel to systems with repair, recovery, redundancy, rollback, reconfiguration, and external support. At each time step, let d_t be structural consumption and r_t be recovery. Define net structural consumption by

$$b_t = d_t - r_t.$$

For a finite horizon n ,

$$B_n = \sum_{t < n} b_t.$$

Then the feasible-region mass satisfies

$$m(V^{(n)}) = m(V^{(0)})e^{-B_n}.$$

With the resource-side term,

$$S_n = M_n e^{-B_n}.$$

This does not replace the minimal kernel. If $r_t = 0$, then $B_n = L_n$. The central claim is that, in recovery-aware systems, structural persistence is governed by net consumption rather than consumption alone.

1 Question

Structures are not only consumed. Software can roll back or add redundancy. Organizations can repair routines or redistribute authority. Reasoning systems can rescope, refresh dependencies, or use external notes. Learning systems can replay, separate adapters, or resynchronize along dependencies.

For such systems, the relevant quantity is not only how much structure has been consumed. It is how much has been consumed relative to how much has been recovered.

This difference is the balance principle of structural persistence. Here “balance” means accounting, not equilibrium. It means that consumption and recovery are read on the same logarithmic scale and then subtracted.

2 Two-step update

Let X be a system, and let

$$V^{(t)} \subseteq X$$

be the feasible region compatible with maintaining the target structure at time t . A finite measure m is fixed in advance. The target structure, measure, observation unit, and time horizon are also fixed in advance.

Within one observation unit, write the update as

$$V_t^- := K_t(V^{(t)}),$$

$$V^{(t+1)} := R_t(V_t^-).$$

The action K_t consumes feasible structural region. The action R_t recovers feasible structural region.

This two-step notation is an accounting representation within a fixed observation unit. If the actual order of physical interventions changes the endpoint $V^{(t+1)}$, then the net quantity below changes as well.

All log-ratio comparisons are read on positive finite masses. Reaching zero is treated as a collapse boundary.

3 Consumption, recovery, and net consumption

Define structural consumption by

$$d_t = -\log \frac{m(V_t^-)}{m(V^{(t)})}.$$

Define recovery by

$$r_t = \log \frac{m(V^{(t+1)})}{m(V_t^-)}.$$

Both quantities live on the same logarithmic scale.

Define net structural consumption by

$$b_t = d_t - r_t.$$

Then the intermediate set cancels:

$$\begin{aligned} & b_t \\ & = \\ & -\log \frac{m(V^{(t+1)})}{m(V^{(t)})}. \end{aligned}$$

Thus, after the endpoint is fixed, the local net change is read directly as a log-ratio between the starting and ending feasible regions.

4 Cumulative balance and exponential kernel

Let

$$B_n = \sum_{t=0}^{n-1} b_t.$$

Then

$$m(V^{(n)}) = m(V^{(0)})e^{-B_n}.$$

Proof. Since

$$e^{-b_t} = \frac{m(V^{(t+1)})}{m(V^{(t)})},$$

we have

$$\begin{aligned} e^{-B_n} &= \\ &= \prod_{0 \leq t < n} e^{-b_t} \\ &= \prod_{0 \leq t < n} \frac{m(V^{(t+1)})}{m(V^{(t)})} \\ &= \frac{m(V^{(n)})}{m(V^{(0)})}. \end{aligned}$$

Multiplying by $m(V^{(0)})$ gives the result.

With the resource-side term,

$$S_n = M_n e^{-B_n}.$$

When the horizon is clear, write

$$S = M e^{-B}.$$

The term M_n is not derived from this pathwise identity. It represents the effective maintenance surplus available to support the structure.

5 Relation to the minimal form

In the minimal form, recovery is not made explicit. Equivalently, set

$$r_t = 0.$$

Then

$$b_t = d_t,$$

$$B_n = L_n.$$

Therefore

$$S_n = M_{ne}^{-B_n}$$

reduces to

$$S_n = M_{ne}^{-L_n}.$$

The balance principle is thus an extension of the minimal kernel, not a competing kernel. Recovery changes the exponent from cumulative consumption L to cumulative net consumption B .

6 Three local accounting regimes

The signs of b_t give three local accounting regimes.

Condition	Reading
(b_t>0)	consumption-dominant
(b_t=0)	locally maintained
(b_t<0)	recovery-dominant

These are not equilibrium claims. They are local accounting labels on a pre-fixed observation unit.

If two adjacent intervals are merged, then

$$\begin{aligned}
 & b_{t:t+2} \\
 & = \\
 & -\log \frac{m(V^{(t+2)})}{m(V^{(t)})} \\
 & = \\
 & b_t + b_{t+1}.
 \end{aligned}$$

The cumulative quantity B_n is additively coherent under aggregation. The local regime labels, however, are grain-relative. A fine-grained path with consumption followed by recovery may become a locally maintained interval after aggregation.

Therefore, empirical claims about consumption, maintenance, recovery, collapse boundaries, or hitting times require the observation unit, stage sequence, and time horizon to be pre-fixed.

7 Application and limitation

The kernel of this paper is pathwise algebraic. It states that, once the target structure, measure, observation unit, consumption, and recovery are fixed,

$$m(V^{(n)}) = m(V^{(0)})e^{-B_n}.$$

In real domains, one must still decide what structure is being maintained, what measure compares feasible regions, and what observation or inference indicators approximate d_t , r_t , or B_t . Discovery on the same data is not support. Support requires frozen mappings, frozen indicators, baselines, metrics, splits, and decision rules, followed by holdout, future-surface, fresh-archive, or outside-rerun validation.

The paper does not claim that every domain has a unique natural V, m, d_t, r_t . It does not claim that expectation-level tendencies imply high-probability hitting bounds without bounded increments, moment-generating functions, Chernoff/KL structure, margin conditions, or other additional assumptions. It does not claim universal-law closure.

8 Conclusion

The minimal kernel is

$$S = Me^{-L}.$$

The recovery-aware balance kernel is

$$S = Me^{-B}.$$

Here

$$B_n = \sum_{t < n} (d_t - r_t).$$

Recovery does not destroy the exponential form. It changes what enters the exponent. Structural persistence in open systems is therefore governed by cumulative net consumption: what has been consumed, what has been recovered, and what remains as net structural loss.